

 Search

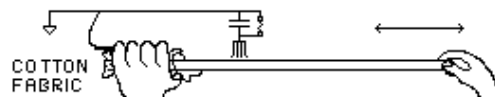
Aussies Are Switching After Seeing This He Comparison

Billy Saving

Static Electricity Generator with PVC Pipe.

The choices of static electricity generator designs that are available seem to be either that of the simple Electrophorus or something much more complicated, such as the Wimshurst machine or the Van de Graaff generator which involve mechanical rotators, motors, belts, pulleys etc. This generator is extremely simple to make, but fills in much of the huge performance gap that exists between the Electrophorus and the Wimshurst machines etc.

The generator is made by using a piece of 3/4 inch pvc pipe about four feet long and a piece of cotton fabric. Paper seems to work quite well also. To operate, one simply holds the fabric or paper with the left hand wrapped around the pipe. The pipe is then pushed and pulled through the fabric, with large strokes, while holding the pipe near some fine wire tip pickups to collect the charge. The wire tip pickups can be connected to a leyden jar or electrostatic motor etc. It is also a good idea to hold in the left hand, along with the fabric, a piece of metal that is connected to ground. This gives the generator a good voltage reference point and keeps the body from building up a big charge that will zap you the next time you touch a grounded object.



Electrostatic Generator

With the spark gap set at about 1/4 inch, a spark can be produced across it with almost every stroke of the pipe. This PVC pipe generator does a very good job of running an electrostatic motor like the one described [here](#). This generator worked well for me even on a very wet rainy day.

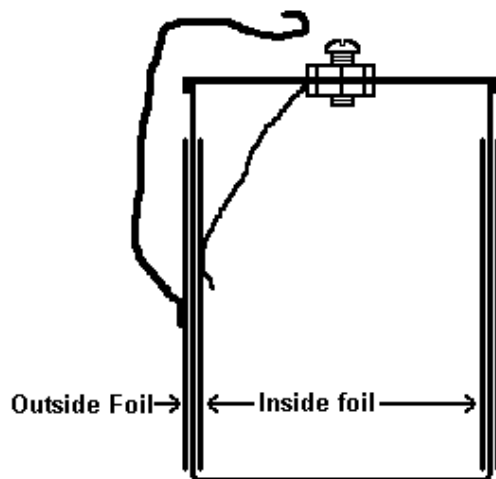


Static Generator.

Film Can Capacitor (Leyden Jar).

The electrostatic generator needs a place to store and build up an electric charge. Without the capacitor, a static generator such as the one made with PVC pipe would have to be operated in a very dark room in order to see any sparks produced. The capacitor stores up enough of a charge to make a very visible spark in broad daylight and, can also be heard.

Film Can Capacitor (Leyden Jar)



The picture of the film can leyden jar is self explanatory. Now days, a film "can" is really plastic

but it is a kind of plastic that makes a great capacitor. The inside foil can be taped to the wall or secured any way you want, so long as it makes good contact with the wall. One person wrote back and reported that the film can exploded as a result of using rubber cement to glue the inside foil to the wall. Rubber cement is highly flammable and explosive and was set off by sparking inside.

28 Mar. 1996. Updated 2 Oct. 1999

[Sparkbangbuzz Home page.](#)